history. This is done through monuments, teachings, art, architecture, protocols and public policy. In fact, as Michele L. Norris explained in June 2021, ‘The country looks at its Nazi past consistently, almost obsessively, memorialising the victims of that murderous era, so much so that it is now a central feature of the nation’s cultural landscape.’[2] It refers to the national process of self-analysis and self-examination that consists of a public debate within Germany on a problematic period of its recent history during the time of National Socialism that led to traumatic events, which raised for the Germans sensitive questions of collective culpability. The term originally connoted the German people’s remorse for their complicity in the war crimes of the Wehrmacht and the Holocaust. As such, the word ‘*Vergangenheitsbewältigung*’ refers also to a psychic process of denazification and is a way by which Germany sets out to come to terms with the excesses and human rights abuses of its past. Would it be too much to expect the same with respect to what happened during a hundred years of the British Raj?

Before this question is answered, it is worth remembering that there is significant historic evidence of feelings of penance, atonement and reparation being expressed by individual persons long before decolonization was ever on the horizon. The premise, therefore, that we cannot judge the standards of the past from the vantage point of the present is a false one. This is because there already exists a reference point of people in the past, speaking in precisely the same historical epoch, who disagreed with the ‘civilising’ mission of the colonizer, to which we can turn for revealing insights. These show how evil was still described as evil by many in those days. It was not just Churchill who described the Jallianwala Bagh as ‘monstrous’ and chose to publicly disagree with General Dyer on that one occasion. There were others. And they were consistent in their opposition to this so-called ‘civilising’ mission. These feelings were expressed amongst the colonizers themselves during the British Raj. If that is so, is it so altogether unrealistic to speak of atonement and restitution now? One need only look at Charles Freer Andrews, a Christian educator and social reformer, who perhaps put it best when, in